



After-Action Review

Cyclones Idai and Kenneth Mozambique, Malawi and Zimbabwe

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Executive Summary

What went well

Crisis Board and HQs coordination
SURGE mission (timely, relevant)
Rapid ERA deployments
Support to RCOs
PDNA-DRF-Donor Conference-Facility



What could be improved

Immediate projects slow to launch
UNDP role in Early Recovery unclear
Socio-economic Impact Assessment
Linking HRP to DRF (Mozambique)
SURGE transition (Mozambique)

Key Recommendations

Contingency planning in at-risk countries

Clarify future of Early Recovery Cluster
Clarify UNDP role in Early Recovery

Crisis Board to make clear “all in” decision

Boost operational support to Country Offices:

- Develop an “Office in a Box” package
- Develop simplified admin procedures
- Deploy UNDP staff as first responders
- Provide operational support at the start
- Ensure conditions for deployee success
- Deepen the deployee roster

Two-phase SURGE Plan w/3 month update

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Context





Each affected country has a unique institutional setup for disaster management.

Broadly-speaking, Zimbabwe and Malawi had National Disaster Management Agencies that were able to cope with their responses (with international support), but Mozambique did not have an NDMA strong enough to coordinate a response to a sudden onset crisis of this scale.

At the time of the cyclones, all three countries were already responding to droughts (Zimbabwe, Mozambique) or earlier floods (Malawi).

Malawi (21 May 2019) and Mozambique (15 October 2019) were also preparing for national elections.

In this crisis there were three separate weather events:

- (1) **floods in Malawi (7 March)** resulting from the tropical storm Idai (before it moved back to sea and subsequently became a cyclone)
- (2) **wind and especially flood damage in Mozambique (15 March) and in Zimbabwe (16 March), and then**
- (3) **floods from cyclone Kenneth in Mozambique (25 April)**



Mozambique was the most affected country. The impact in Zimbabwe was severe but very concentrated in one region. In Malawi the impact was less intense but more widespread (fewer deaths but many people affected for longer).

Impact	Malawi	Mozambique	Zimbabwe	Total
Deaths	59	603	344	1,006
Injuries	672	1,600	186	2,458
Displacement	87,000	142,000	16,000	245,000
Affected people	868,900	1,850,000	270,000	2,988,900
Damaged/destroyed Houses		239,700	4,000	243,700

CO spending targets and actuals, and core:non-core spending ratios

Malawi			
	IWP target	Actual delivery	Core: non-core ratio
2014	31 M	27 M	1:2.14
2015	24 M	21 M	1:1.29
2016	24 M	20 M	1:1.53
2017	47 M	54 M	1:6.03
2018	32 M	38 M	1:2.30

Zimbabwe			
	IWP target	Actual delivery	Core: non-core ratio
2014	150 M	173 M	1:23.21
2015	171 M	183 M	1:28.04
2016	199 M	145 M	1:20.42
2017	180 M	195 M	1:27.60
2018	179 M	206 M	1:59.59

Mozambique			
	IWP target	Actual delivery	Core: non-core ratio
2014	23 M	16 M	1:1.26
2015	15 M	13 M	1:0.78
2016	16 M	14 M	1:1.08
2017	13 M	9 M	1:0.35
2018	14 M	8 M	1:0.29

The 2014-2018 trend for Mozambique shows low spending, decreasing delivery ratio, and low core:non-core ratio

Malawi

CO was mid-sized and well-established. DRR and Team Leader both well-established in country: DRR was acting RR for the emergency response period.

Malawi has a long history of floods: donors are focused on Disaster Risk Reduction and generally felt that the ongoing 2015 flood recovery programme should be continued/stepped up, rather than creating a new recovery programme. Donors were also reluctant to risk politicizing recovery during an active pre-election period.

Zimbabwe

CO was one of the largest and strongest in Africa. RR and Team Leader were both well-established in country.

Zimbabwe has limited experience with sudden-onset disasters but has a chronic problem with droughts. The Government-donor relationship is very tense, with most donors having suspended budget support and placed technical assistance under very close management due to perceived poor governance. Donors are very reluctant to consider any new assistance to Government, or even redirecting existing aid programmes.

Mozambique

CO had been drastically cut back during 2018 downsizing and the programme was seen as poor-performing. At the time of the cyclone, there was no RR, DRR (Programme) or Team Leader in place, and the office was severely demoralised.

Mozambique has periodic severe floods and cyclones, but had never experienced anything as major as cyclone Idai. Donors are generally well-disposed towards Mozambique, which was the 10th largest aid recipient in Africa in 2018.



Timeline of UNDP response to Cyclone Idai

External events

UNDP events

Key Deployments

- 7 - 8 March flooding in Malawi (from storm Idai before it went back to sea and returned as a cyclone)
- 9 March Malawi declares State of Disaster
- 11 March Pre-cyclone meeting in Mozambique convened by Government. RBA alerted by CO
- 15 March Idai strikes Mozambique
- 17 March Mozambique declares State of Emergency
- 19 March Zimbabwe declares State of Disaster
- 21 March Crisis Board convenes for the first time: approves L2 response and initial resources
- 21 March RBA communicates internally that they are planning a SEIA
- 22 March Ad Hoc IASC meeting to decide on L2 response and system scale-up
- 26 March ERA deployee arrives Malawi
- 30 March Gender deployee arrives Mozambique
- 31 March ERA deployee arrives Zimbabwe
- 31 March RBA management support team (RR a.i, DRR (P) a.i. and Country Analyst) arrive in Mozambique
- 1 - 7 April SURGE mission to Mozambique
- 2 April UNDP Administrator briefs ECOSOC on Idai response: commits to a SEIA
- 2 April ERA deployees arrive Mozambique
- 6 April – 5 May PDNA mission (assessment work started 16 April, and ended 2 May)
- 8 - 11 April SURGE teams visit to Malawi and Zimbabwe
- 9 - 11 April: RBA Director visits Mozambique
- 10 April Fast Track authorities granted to CO Mozambique
- 25 April Cyclone Kenneth strikes Cabo Delgado in Mozambique
- 1 - 25 May DRF expert in Mozambique
- 2 May Crisis Board convenes for the second time: receives and approves SURGE Plan
- 8 May Senior Recovery Advisor arrives in Mozambique
- 13 May Second RR a.i. arrives in Mozambique
- 15 May First operations deployee arrives in Mozambique (procurement expert)
- 15 May OCHA-UNDP briefing of PRs in NY with PRs of the affected countries and donor representatives
- 21 May Malawi elections
- 27 May Livelihoods deployee arrives in Mozambique (becomes OIC Beira office)
- 31 May - 1 June Donor Conference in Beira
- 19 - 22 June Zimbabwe Government lessons learned workshop supported by UNDP
- 4 July - 15 August DRF drafting
- 11 July 2019 UN Secretary-General visits Mozambique and pushes for recovery
- 16 August UNDP and GoM launch the UNDP Recovery Facility



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Reconstruction of what UNDP deployees and staff thought “should have happened” in Mozambique

0 – 3 months	4 – 6 months	7 months onwards	
“Immediate recovery”?	Early recovery	Recovery	
Debris removal (asbestos)	Solid waste management / land use planning		Activities: start small and build. Shift over time from immediate to early recovery, from NGO to Government, from direct delivery to capacity development
Cash For Work	Livelihoods / sustainable economic growth		
Building Damage Assessment	Building technical skills Roofing/shelter		
Resilient design	Building standards Government infrastructure repairs / rebuilding		
Connect Govt with the response	(Govt) recovery planning	DRR and capacity building	UNDP conceptual focus
INGC + Local Governments		National Recovery Authority	Institutional alignment
500k from CB	2-5m new projects + redirected existing \$	70m Facility	Programming and funding sources
Clusters aligned with HCT		Sectors aligned with Govt	Organising principle
ICCG	ICCG and Recovery WG	Recovery WG w/Govt	Coordination bodies
ER mainstreaming (HRP/ICCG)	Linking HRP-DRF (within RCO), facilitate Recovery WG		UNDP ERA role
Develop projects for immediate and early recovery phases		Design Facility projects	UNDP ER/RM Expert
Supports PDNA, donor conference, DRF and Facility design			UNDP SRA role
PDNA		DRF	
Donor conference + Update SURGE plan + Business case for field office			



Findings

This is an After-Action Review, not an evaluation. It aims to provide real-time feedback from participants after an event, and not to be a definitive retrospective analysis. It is also intended for internal use not for general publication.

These findings are mainly the result of interviews with staff and four staff workshops, supplemented by discussions with government authorities, UN agencies (including RCs and OCHA) and civil society partners. Not all staff had the same perspectives or shared the same opinions, and some staff were only involved for a limited period of time. These findings try to fairly reflect the prevailing or majority view, rather than a consensus.

Feedback was provided to country management at the conclusion of each field visit. It seems that the AAR process was itself useful in three ways: (1) the workshops provided opportunities for staff to step back and consider their recent experience, articulate some of their lessons learned and discuss them with their peers, (2) the interviews provided a mechanism for some deployees who have left the region to “close out” their assignments with a debriefing session, and (3) it has reportedly generated some useful team discussions outside the scope of the AAR itself.



Leadership

What went well?

1) Collaboration between the bureaux and strong consensus driven engagement and support

* Coordination between CB/RBA, particularly given the transition from CRO/BPPS to CB/BPPS

Crisis Board

Cooperation between Bureaux within HQs was excellent. Crisis Board meetings were well-organised and the COs felt well-supported. Crisis Board was seen as stronger on tactical decisions but less firm on how UNDP should position itself strategically (see later comments and recommendations on UNDP's role in Early Recovery).

Crisis Board was supported by the Crisis Management Support Team made up of officers from the key Bureaux, handling technical matters and exchanging constantly with the field.

Some senior managers felt there could have been an additional meeting after 3 months to take stock of progress, consider mid-course corrections and to assess the status of transition planning, and another at the end (6 months?) to close the Crisis Response Phase.

The new Crisis Bureau

The restructuring of the organisation to bring several functions back into a single Crisis Bureau has brought more focus, and allowed quick and confident/seamless mustering of the technical resources needed for a strong SURGE Plan and SURGE implementation. "We really got what we were asking for" (RBA). "Really impressive" (CO).

Regional Bureau for Africa

RBA senior management correctly focused on Mozambique. Field visits by the Director (early) and Deputy Director (mid-stream) were highly appreciated by CO staff and were seen by outsiders as key to turning around Government and donor views of UNDP's commitment to and value-added in the recovery.

RBA deployments to temporarily fill vacant key positions in the Mozambique CO were essential.

With RBA's substantial support, the Maputo office managed to keep up with the response but were not strong enough to lead on early recovery in the crisis phase. A clear direction for UNDP in Mozambique in the early/crisis phase might have been established easier and quicker if the RBA deployees had been able to stay for longer, and if permanent appointments had been made sooner to head the CO and the Beira office.

RBA could have helped the CO by reducing the operations burden of "normal business" during the emergency.



Leadership

“Perfect Storm” affecting UNDP Mozambique.

Four factors combined to create a very difficult situation for CO Maputo:

1. de-linking and delayed RC recruitment meant there was no empowered RC in place,
2. despite best efforts by RBA to fill key gaps, CO interim management was not experienced in recovery and large scale disaster response, or empowered to make strategic decisions regarding a new field office or UNDP staffing,
3. the CO had been through wrenching downsizing leaving no DRM Team Leader, national staff demoralised and overworked,

And then

4. there was the largest sudden-onset emergency in recent history.

Country Offices

The pre-crisis CO capacities were very different across the three countries: broadly speaking the strongest CO was least affected (Zimbabwe), and the weakest CO was most affected (Mozambique). In Zimbabwe and Malawi the COs took ownership over the UNDP response, directed the course of action and guided the deployed experts.

The Mozambique CO struggled to respond. Because employees necessarily stepped in to fill some key CO functions, and there were significant supervisor rotations and absences on leave or mission, some field employees felt that reporting lines were not clear, and technical employees in particular felt disconnected from their CO counterparts.

NOT ENOUGH STAFF
AND SENIOR MANAGERS
TO ALLOW ^{for} WHAT WOULD
HAVE BEEN A NORMAL
UNDP RESPONSE

In Mozambique the interim senior management team succeeded in re-establishing confidence in UNDP and built an important recovery programme, but six months after the cyclone this recovery programme was still largely “owned” by employees, and not yet fully anchored within the CO.

De-linking the RC function from UNDP

De-linking did not affect Zimbabwe’s or Malawi’s ability to respond, but the absence of an empowered RC/HC did inhibit the Mozambique response, in particular the forging *ab initio* of stronger linkages between the humanitarian and development mechanisms.

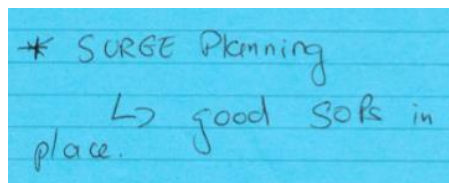
The combination of de-linking with the lack of clarity around the Global Cluster for Early Recovery left all RC/HCs and some COs uncertain as to what should be the role of UNDP in a humanitarian crisis beyond integrating early recovery into the response. “UNDP cannot win: when UNDP coordinates it is seen as self-serving, but now they are liberated they are perceived as not coordinating enough” (RCO). However, Mozambique also demonstrates that UNDP can position itself as central to recovery without the “cover” of the RC function.

In all three countries, Government counterparts were confused about the roles of the RCO vs UNDP, and Government officials who are not well-connected with UN agencies were more broadly confused about the difference between all UN agencies. In interviews, many government officials tended to remember individual people rather than institutions.



Crisis Response

What went well?



Unresolved question: if the SURGE Plan is not the CO strategy for short-term ER in that situation, then who should develop a country-specific ER strategy/plan and what would it look like?

SURGE planning mission

The SURGE planning mission was recognized as timely: it is noteworthy that the first wave of ERAs was deployed before or during the SURGE mission, so they were able to connect with the SURGE mission and thereby enhance coherence and continuity. The SURGE mission was absolutely required for Mozambique, and it was regarded as helpful to both Malawi and Zimbabwe even though both those offices were strong and the countries were relatively less affected. The team composition was seen as well-balanced: there was also representation from the UNDP RBA regional hub, however some CO staff felt that a team member from the HQs RBA country oversight team could have participated alongside Crisis Bureau HQs staff, and that this might have facilitated contextual understanding.

SURGE Plan

The SURGE Plan managed the difficult task of covering in one Plan three countries with very different contexts. It had an innovative two-phase approach reflecting different stages of recovery, and clearly reached forward to position UNDP for the future by placing emphasis on bridging to the long-term, including clear anticipation of a donor conference and a disaster recovery framework for Mozambique.

Beyond some initial suggestions, the SURGE Plan did not aim to provide specific direction to COs on what UNDP should do immediately with the quick-release funds provided by the Crisis Bureau. It was felt by the SURGE team that this short-term planning was something that the CO needed to work out, with support of experts deployed in the first wave of SURGE deployments and based upon the active processes of needs assessment and humanitarian planning under way at that time. However, if it is understood that the SURGE Plan is not the UNDP Plan for the first six months but rather a resourcing and enabling document, then the question remains: who is responsible for pulling that UNDP short-term plan together? This was a task usually delegated to the ERA deployees, but this was not their primary mandate and possibly not their skillset. **This seems to be a gap in the system.**

Some stakeholders felt the SURGE Plan could have been improved in two ways:

1) while the Plan's two-phased approach was widely welcomed, operational support was clearly needed in Mozambique in the first phase (it was identified in the plan but not deployed until later), and some staff in Mozambique (the main focus of the Plan) felt that there should have been an update of the Plan at the three-month mark, preferably conducted by one of the original SURGE team-members, in order to confirm and adjust the second wave of deployments in light of experience to date.

2) perhaps because of de-linking, the SURGE Plan was rather UNDP-centric: notably the "Phased Approach" and "Areas of recovery support" made no reference to UNDP's role in providing Early Recovery advice to the RCO, to mainstreaming Early Recovery in the HRP and in other clusters, or to the coordination of (post-cluster) Early Recovery Working Groups. While the Plan did refer to the strategic advisory role of ERAs in the description of ERA functions, it contributed to confusion about the ERA role by also stating that the ERA's primary role is to support UNDP to plan and deliver a recovery program.



EXCELLENT
SURGE
DEPLOYMENTS

Crisis Response Deployments

Successful deployee package:

1. TORs tailored to the context and fully owned by the CO
2. Senior manager in CO responsible for the assignment, and if necessary (depending on context) supported by an operational “one stop shop” for the deployee
3. Necessary support in-country (interpreter if needed, vehicle if needed, IT/work tools if needed)
4. Clear workplan and deliverables agreed with the responsible CO manager

Deployee effectiveness

Most field staff remarked on the speed and quality of the SURGE deployments. However, operations support was deployed too late to Mozambique - which was not able to support itself after the downsizing, still less the half dozen UNDP and dozen OCHA deployees relying on UNDP financial, procurement and IT support. Experts deployed to Mozambique with regional functions were less effective outside Mozambique (due to limited employee availability, and lack of demand/readiness on the part of Malawi and Zimbabwe).

don't Think much of
Operational
Capabilities
vs.
Programmatic
Capabilities

UNDP staff were generally seen as more effective and were certainly quicker to become operational than ICs and standby partners, but reportedly several UNDP staff requests for SURGE/crisis deployment were denied by their UNDP managers – suggesting that there is **not yet sufficient agency-wide support for crisis response**.

SURGE deployees all come with their own experience and ideas, and this can lead to a scattered or incoherent response unless they get strong guidance from the CO based on a clear vision of UNDP's role. Since in the early months there was not a sufficiently clear vision of UNDP's role (especially regarding UNDP's role in early recovery), many deployees found themselves pulled in several directions. This affected Mozambique most of all.

No clear vision and
Direction for UNDP
to respond to
Disaster at the initial
stage

Despite the absence in Mozambique of early recovery programming in the first few months, which limited the impact of the technical deployees, Government officials at national and local levels did appreciate the technical advice regarding waste management, building codes and asbestos: demonstrating that to some extent advice without a programme is still useful: “UNDP is an organisation that is with us always” (Government official).

Communications

Other agencies had reportedly developed strong messages and pushed them out to the donors and to the general public before UNDP – leaving a sense that UNDP was lagging somehow in communications. One complication was that UNDP was trying to communicate this as a regional response and endeavoured to coordinate the narrative and the messaging across 3 very different country contexts.



INADEQUATE / LACK OF
INVOLVEMENT FROM THE
COUNTRY OFFICE
OVERDEPENDENCE ON
SURGE EXPERTS (SOME
NOT SPEAKING PORTUGUESE)

Lack of clear reporting
Structure for Beira
Sub-office

NO SYSTEMS
IN PLACE
UNV'S TRANSPORT ^{LATORS} ~~TRANS~~

The Beira field office

In Mozambique, in addition to the perceived disconnect between the SURGE deployees and the CO team, there was a strong sense in the Beira office that they were disconnected from Maputo - especially from Maputo operational support.

As prescribed in the SOPs, a country-level Crisis Response Team was created to coordinate the response. The CRT met regularly, but the field perception is that the CRT did not provide enough direction and support to the field.

For the first few months, employees visiting Beira and standby partner technical experts used the office as a base for their activities, but the office did not have an empowered OIC (fixed term staff-member with local authority over procurement and staffing) with a clear management relationship with the CO, and the field operation did not have a clear plan. As a result the Beira office drifted: "nobody was running the UNDP office here," (employee), and the field did not generate projects in the initial emergency phase.

Immediately after the donor conference an OIC was appointed and there was a country-wide UNDP planning retreat that clarified the medium to long-term direction, but these measures did not fully address the communications gap or resolve the lack of field signing authorities.

A second consequence of the perceived disconnect between Maputo and Beira was that technically skilled deployees (particularly from standby partners) were not directed and supported in ways that allowed them to be fully effective: "Not 10% of our skills are being used" (employee).

How to set up a field office (lessons learned from the Beira experience):

1. Have an Office-in-a-box (see next page) to allow the first deployees to hit the ground running - out of a hotel room or shared office space
2. Assign an OIC with signing authority (consultant with temporary appointment contract, or deployed international staff, or preferably senior National Officer)
3. Using existing policies and wavers to immediately recruit logistical and administrative support on temporary local contracts, and deploy a project officer from the CO if the plan is to develop and manage projects in field
4. Ensure clear reporting relationships and lines of communication with CO: there needs to be a CO senior manager for the OIC relationship, and an operational focal point for operational and administrative matters
5. Conduct business case analysis regarding the medium-term future of the office. On that basis, after 3 months: decide whether to wind the office up, or to maintain the office for the longer term, and to procure long-term office space

Crisis Response

Office-in-a-box

In situations where deployed staff have to set up a field operation (beyond an individual advisory deployment), UNDP should ensure that they are provided with adequate operational support (administration and finance, and possibly logistics and procurement), and provide them with a new Crisis Bureau tool: an office-in-a-box. Especially if the deployee is an IC and does not have UNDP-supplied laptop and procurement authority, then the Box needs to be fully stocked for a month of use.

In this office-in-a-box there should be a number of actual things, perhaps all contained within in actual box – i.e. a large lockable suitcase. But just as importantly, the office-in-a-box could come with soft components. If the deployee is UNDP staff, then the box should come with exceptional emergency delegated authorities for local procurement and staff recruitment, together with simplified procedures and template TORs and contracts, so that a deployee can get up and running in an orderly way and within pre-approved limits.

Cash and/or pre-paid credit cards could be kept in a lock box and the combination could be e-mailed separately only to the deployee to enhance security and accountability.

Suggested contents of an office-in-a-box (estimated cost <USD 5,000 excluding cash/credit components)

IM/IT

- Laptop configured for the printer, with preloaded APPs and templates
- Wireless compact printer with spare ink cartridges
- Flash drives and/or data cards - Voice recorder (for recording coordination meetings)
- Basic international smartphone with dual SIMs, case and basic preloaded APPs (document scanner, google maps, skype, whatsapp etc) – Satellite phone with pre-paid plan (in situations of high security risk)
- Universal external battery pack and spare charger cord - Digital camera with compatible audio connection
- Solar lamp/solar charger for mobile phone (or larger version available for laptops)
- Security camera kit with SD card - Multi-outlet extension cord - Universal socket travel adapter

Office supplies

- Paper, stapler and staples, pens etc - Latch and padlock for temporary office door - UNDP stamp

Visibility materials

- Large adhesive logos for the office door and vehicles - Small adhesive logos for general use
- T-shirts, caps and vests (several sizes) - UNDP notebooks - Blank UNDP business cards

General equipment

- Swiss army knife - Small toolbox - Flashlights and rechargeable batteries - First aid kit
- Personal kit (sunscreen, bug spray, water purification tablets) – Mosquito net

Administration and Finance

- Combination locked cash box - Accountable cash advance (accessible with cash box access code)
- Accountable pre-paid credit card(s) for \$5,000 (accessible with cash box code)
- Receipt book - Account ledger - Blank contracts for purchase of good and services
- Blank procurement offers (that contractors can complete and hand in for local competitive bidding)
- Generic TORs for essential support positions (office admin, driver, security guard, finance clerk etc)
- Generic lease for temporary office or staff accommodation – Micro purchasing templates

Guidelines in a stand-alone emergency field manual

- Emergency delegated authorities and simplified processes for local procurement of low-value goods and services
- Guidelines, authorities and simplified processes for temporary local staff recruitment
- Field coordination guide including a guide to UNDP's role in early recovery coordination
- Protocol on communicating with the media and with donors

In any given situation, this generic kit should be supplemented with two sets of information that are location-specific and provided by the Country Office:

- CO information kit on a flash drive, containing key CO documents such as UNDAF, CPD, ongoing project documents, any CO specific SOPs/procedures, and a full CO staff list with contact details and titles
- Contact details of UN clinics, DSS, other agencies and external resources and service providers



UN
DP

Crisis response SURGE Transition

Lessons Learned:

Technical support
in response to
disasters and recovery
should have a longer
time span - frequent
turnover should be
avoided.

SURGE transition

Malawi and Zimbabwe had light deployments into large COs, the SURGE supported the COs, and the COs fully owned the deployments from the start. In these two offices there are still needs for employee support, but this support is tactical and with vigilance and careful planning the COs should be sufficiently resourced to assume full responsibility for follow-on activities.

This was not the case for Mozambique, where the SURGE team carried the major load, supported by the CO team (especially for advocacy and Government engagement). As a result CO Mozambique did not fully own the recovery program until late 2019 when newly-recruited staff started to take on their full responsibilities.

In the opinion of Maputo and Beira workshop participants, three things are needed for the SURGE transition in Mozambique: (a) full staffing of the CO to the level needed to double its programme volume, (b) full establishment of the Beira office including an empowered OIC, an autonomous PMU and clear reporting lines to Maputo, and (c) an active programme of transfer of knowledge and ongoing activities from SURGE deployees to an enlarged CO team, so that the new recovery programme is fully anchored in the CO.

RBA and the CO are well aware of the need to step up the pace on transition, and plans are under way to carry out the three measures outlined above. Nevertheless, from a lessons learned perspective, transition planning could have begun as soon as UNDP received firm Government and donor commitments for a UNDP-managed recovery, and transition (recruitment in particular) should have been substantially completed by mid-September. If that were not possible (e.g. due to administrative time-lag) then decisions could have been taken earlier to extend key deployees, such that there is not a risk of break in continuity. Some UNDP staff felt that a Crisis Board meeting at the three-month mark, at the same time as an update to the Mozambique SURGE plan, would have helped UNDP Senior Management take stock of the state of transition readiness, and would have provided either a SURGE extension, or a renewed sense of urgency.

TO CO:

- TO ESTABLISH A FULLY-FLEDGED PMU IN BEIRA WITH DoA AND ADMIN, PROCUREMENT CAPACITY
- TO ESTABLISH URGENT MANAGEMENT ACTIONS TO ENSURE WORKFLOWS, RESPONSIBILITIES, ACCOUNTABILITY PROCEDURES
- TO ESTABLISH CLEAR REPORTING LINES

Lesson learned

By keeping an active relationship with the World Bank and the EU outside crisis periods, through joint assessment and joint missions etc, a strong relationship is built that is quickly converted to stronger cooperation in a crisis.



Early Recovery Cluster activation

Zimbabwe 2019-2020 appeal

ANNEX

EARLY RECOVERY PLAN CYCLONE IDAI (SYNOPSIS)



**\$80
MILLION**
Total required
(Feb 2019 - Apr 2020)

A coherent Early Recovery Plan was developed through UNDP coordination to support government efforts. The plan equips partners/stakeholders to make evidence-based decisions on early recovery/recovery and sustainable long-term development. It emphasizes a shift from saving lives to restoring livelihoods, effectively preventing the recurrence of crisis situations; harnessing conditions for future development; building national capacities; empowering all members of the affected communities; determining and addressing the root causes and vulnerabilities including developing measures for anticipating future hazards, their prevention, preparedness, response and recovery.

The Plan presents by sectors time critical action-oriented interventions for addressing the transitional early recovery needs of the affected population over a 12-month period. Special

Zimbabwe workshop

Positioning UNDP as an ER lead was a bit of challenge – internally and also within the intercluster team.

The Early Recovery Cluster

The Country Offices were generally aware that UNDP had made a decision to no longer activate the Early Recovery (ER) cluster, but (a) some RC/HCs, partners and CO staff were not aware of this and encouraged or expected cluster activation, and (b) Country Offices were unclear as to what UNDP's role should be in an immediate response - in the absence of a cluster. Zimbabwe and Mozambique created Early Recovery Working Groups (ERWG), and in Malawi ER was integrated within the "Coordination Cluster" according to local practice. The Zimbabwe ERWG was the most cluster-like of the three countries, and even had an ER chapter as an annexe in the 2019 appeal. Rather awkwardly, this cyclone ER annexe was annexed to an appeal for the preceding and ongoing food security crisis: thus, the Appeal did not describe two different phases of response, but described one humanitarian problem in the main document, and a different humanitarian problem in the annexe.

COs reported that when they tried to engage in the humanitarian space there was push-back from other agencies: "Humanitarian agencies said that we are all doing ER, why is UNDP talking about ER" (CO Mozambique), "UNDP struggled to get the Humanitarian community together here (Mozambique) to respect UNDP's role in ER" (UN agency). In Zimbabwe there was concern on the part of humanitarian clusters that the ERWG was overlapping with them on coordination (food security and cash) and data collection, and in some cases not following inter-cluster guidance. Zimbabwe stakeholders would have preferred no separate ERWG - but rather, more ER mainstreaming support for other clusters. Zimbabwe CO was also called upon by Government to coordinate ER thinking in four thematic areas, underlining their perceived value-added in ER mainstreaming.

With the exception of two UNDP staff (out of 113 interviewees and workshop participants), no person interviewed felt that UNDP should have activated a conventional Early Recovery Cluster. Most respondents said this would have created confusion with other clusters and Government, and distracted UNDP from its focus on the medium-term and implementation of its own activities.

In Mozambique there is a gap between the humanitarian and development responses (a programming gap after the end of the HRP in May 2020 before the main development programmes come onstream, and also some sectoral gaps such as private housing) – but it was still felt that an Early Recovery Cluster would not have addressed this gap. What was needed in Mozambique was better strategic planning linking the HRP and the DRF (for which the new RC later received support from UNDP), more deliberate attempts to align the HRP and DRF designs, and some more flexibility in both approaches.



What is UNDP's role in Early Recovery?

- From the BEGINNING,
ALL ACTORS EXPECT
CLEAR GUIDANCE FROM
UNDP ON EARLY RECV.

UNDP's Early Recovery dilemma

UNDP staff involved in the Idai response were divided into two camps regarding the appropriate UNDP response to a sudden-onset natural disaster.

- Some UNDP staff [and some Government officials] believed that UNDP should work in humanitarian mode: engage quickly with meaningful programming in the earliest crisis response stage, gain access, visibility and funding in the immediate response, and follow up with medium and long-term support. Others [and all other UN agencies and humanitarian responders] believed that UNDP's comparative advantage is in the mid-late response and that UNDP should forgo the humanitarian moment and instead focus upon Government and structural issues of recovery: "Our greatest strength comes in our post disaster work and in the reconstruction," (UNDP senior manager).
- When both points of view were present in the UNDP office at the same and there was no clear position (Mozambique in the first few months), this fed confusion and frustration, the immediate response was hesitant, and UNDP appeared from the outside to be confused.

Recommendation:

Because the nature of UNDP's role in ER is so dependent upon the specific context, UNDP should explicitly consider this question of UNDP's focus at the first Crisis Board. Factors would include the nature of the situation, Host Government requests, resource availability, UNDP's in-country capacity, and UNDP's strategic position in-country. This early direction would then frame the SURGE planning mission.

- If the decision is made to implement a meaningful immediate response, then **UNDP must go all-in and fully commit to make immediate delivery the priority**: with a clear statement from senior management, substantial resources, immediate fast-track authorities, relief from routine reporting on the regular program, rapid operational deployments alongside the technical teams, deploy or designate a dedicated senior recovery coordinator in-country, deploy or designate an officer dedicated to launching UNDP's immediate (0-6 month) programming, and make an early senior management visit. This could then be followed with the mid to long-term support package. Going all-in is resource-intensive and should only be done in a few situations where the conditions for success are all in place.
- If the decision is made to focus on the mid to long-term, then **communicate this clearly**, mobilise a different deployee skillset with emphasis on recovery needs assessment, recovery planning, strengthening the capacity of government institutions, and resource mobilisation for mid to long-term programming (6 months – 5 years).

If UNDP retains its IASC role as the technical authority on ER in humanitarian contexts, then **in both cases UNDP should also deploy an Early Recovery Advisor** with responsibility for engaging with all clusters and the HCT in order to mainstream ER across the response, and for supporting the Government recovery machinery and/or key line ministries to take over recovery coordination from OCHA and the ICCG.



What could an Early Recovery Working Group do?

All Country Offices activated some sort of Early Recovery Working Group, either within the Coordination Cluster (Malawi) or alongside the humanitarian clusters (Zimbabwe and Mozambique). UNDP staff approaches to these Working Groups varied, and some humanitarian actors had difficulty understanding the role of a working group in the cluster system.

In the case of Mozambique the ERWG faded after an initial period and then re-set itself as a support to the Government reconstruction agency with the aim of transitioning humanitarian clusters to government sectors/line ministries.

Suggested purpose of an Early Recovery Working Group

Experience from the three countries suggests that an ERWG could do these things in sequence. There is no set pattern for early recovery – this is very highly contextual, so the relevance of these steps and the length of each stage would be variable:

1. Initial stage (approx. 0-3 months): the ERWG (or as in Malawi, a sub-group of the overall response coordination body) provides a forum for recovery and development actors to:

- a) understand the emergency response and to start to identify recovery priorities,
- b) support the conduct and dissemination of the PDNA, and
- c) engage with Government authorities (national and local) who will be central to recovery

[At the same time, outside the ERWG, the ERA is providing advice to other clusters and to the HCT on ER mainstreaming in the humanitarian response]

2. Transition stage (approx. 4-6 months): enlarge the ERWG to include recovery-oriented humanitarian stakeholders (“recovery officers”), humanitarian cluster leads, (development) sector leads, donor representatives and concerned government agencies, to:

- a) decide the main recovery priorities,
- b) support the drafting of the Disaster Recovery Framework, and
- c) plan the transition of ICCG-coordinated humanitarian clusters to government-coordinated recovery sectors (mapping and alignment of activities, transfer of studies and data, transfer of technical expertise etc.)

3. Recovery stage (approx. 7 months onwards): if there is a significant Government recovery programme, then the ERWG becomes an external stakeholder forum supporting the implementation of the Government’s recovery plan by:

- a) mapping/aligning ongoing humanitarian activity as it transitions to recovery, and
- b) providing technical support to Government-led recovery initiatives

Note: at no point does the ERWG become a fund-raising or programme implementation body, both of which set it up in competition with other clusters for resources. Acceptance and usefulness are likely to be greater if its purpose is uniquely to share information including information on resource-mobilisation opportunities, to plan, and to provide technical support.



Early Recovery Programming (0-6 months)

Early Recovery programming

In practice, programming was of three types: (a) immediate action using the SURGE funding of \$500,000 per country (debris clearance, immediate cash for work, pilot housing projects), (b) early recovery programming using project funding from China (all), World Bank (Zimbabwe) or internally reallocated resources, and (c) long-term recovery using new sources of structural funding (Mozambique Recovery Facility).

In all three countries, the “immediate” programming was with NGO partners: Zimbabwe started after three months and the others started a few months later. At the time of the AAR (six months) all are being implemented but none are near completion.

All partners of the “immediate” programming had very positive views of their relationship with UNDP, although the projects were small (\$120K – \$400K) and rather labour-intensive both for partners and for UNDP. In Mozambique, initial indecision about whether to focus on immediate response (i.e. debris or not?) and lack of field staff dedicated to launching immediate programming meant that standby partner technical experts were deployed without projects to advise or to implement.

MWI:
MOZ: EARLY RECOVERY
PROJECT ACTIVITIES
STARTED LATE
DUE TO LACK OF PROGRAMME
AND PROJECT EXPERTS TO KICKSTART
ER PROJECT ACTIVITIES IN
DISASTER AFFECTED DISTRICTS

Mozambique	Zimbabwe	Malawi
\$160k for CfW with local NGO Adel	400k for CfW for irrigation rehab with CARE	200k for 33 transitional houses with Malawi Red Cross
\$160k for Micro Finance and Waste Management with local NGO CAM		210k for 20 transitional houses with Habitat for Humanity
\$187k for training and model house construction with local NGO Young Africa	100k to support needs assessments	90k to support PDNA, ERA and Flood Recovery Planning costs

Most of the early resource-mobilisation effort seems to have been focused upon securing funding from China (successfully: \$5M divided between the three countries). Some effort to obtain funding from India seems not have borne fruit yet. In Mozambique there was reportedly also an early attempt to secure ER funding from CERF, and initial work on the design of an MPTF was superseded by a decision to create a locally-managed Basket Fund (see discussion below on the Facility).



Support for the UN system and for Host Government Planning

PDNAs

What went well

Adjusting Response to Country specific needs

①
Timely PDNA - and the Donor conference.

Initial needs assessments

Zimbabwe CO participated in the very first Inter-Agency Needs Assessment in the days following the cyclone, but neither the Malawi nor Mozambique COs participated in theirs (Malawi was not invited to participate by the HC/HCT). UNDP first responders in Beira city participated in an early assessment on 29 March but the assessment did not generate useable data. Zimbabwe also attempted to assemble all the cluster Needs Assessments and package them for Government information (not yet finished and difficult because the assessments were not compatible). In the end, in Zimbabwe there were 4 Assessments plus the agency assessments (see graphic) but there was no appetite for a PDNA on the part of the PDNA stakeholders (not wanting to raise funding expectations in a difficult donor environment) or Government. Instead, UNDP participated in the World Bank's Rapid Impact and Needs Assessment.



PDNAs

PDNAs were carried out in Mozambique (full-scale and very rapidly with a significant external expert team and considerable UNDP leadership), and Malawi (PDNA-lite mainly with in-country expertise and without EU participation).

The Mozambique PDNA was highly regarded, and when linked to the Donor Conference and the DRF provided a very strong strategic backbone to the Mozambique recovery, as well as positioning UNDP as the principal Government and donor partner for a substantial recovery programme. The PDNA was the key that unlocked the door.

While the Malawi PDNA had less splash, the level of coordination and cooperation between UNDP and World Bank was signaled by World Bank as better than in the previous PDNA a few years earlier, and it triggered a significant release of World Bank resources.

With support from a dedicated Gender Advisor, the GEEWG analysis and integration was better in the Mozambique PDNA (in comparison with UNDP's response to Hurricanes Irma and Maria), and there was stronger engagement from UN Women despite their lack of experience in this domain. UNDP's ongoing partnership with UN Women should also help the initial GEEWG analysis carry through to the Facility, and GEEWG support for the Government Recovery Agency.



Support for the UN system and for Host Government Planning

SEIA

Socio-Economic Impact Assessment

Kicking off from an initial request from the Zimbabwe CO for analysis of the impact upon land-locked countries of the cyclone damage to Beira port, UNDP undertook a socio-economic impact assessment across all three countries.

The SEIA was mandated and guided by RBA and conducted by the region's network of country economists, separately from the PDNA and to a large extent in isolation of the COs.

The SEIA changed approach: from (a) a situation overview with quick and qualitative assessment and no costing, to (b) three in-depth country reports, and finally to (c) a consolidated regional report where the country detail was reduced to the lowest common denominators of the three country reports. It also used a different methodology from the PDNA, resulting in damage and loss or recovery cost estimates that were different from the PDNAs.

SHIFTING GOAL-
POSTS IN SOCIO-
ECONOMIC IMPACT
ASSESSMENT

The interim country-specific version of the SEIA was used in Zimbabwe (instead of a PDNA) for internal planning and resource-mobilisation, but it was not made public and the data was soon superseded because of the rapid deterioration of the economy.

Lack of coordination
between RBA and
crisis Bureau regarding
the assessments, i.e.,
PDNA VS SOCIOECONOMIC
ASSESSMENT

In Mozambique and Malawi the SEIA was regarded as HQs-driven rather than demand-led, and as a strategic error creating significant reputational risk for UNDP – in particular in relation to host governments and the World Bank (often criticized by UNDP for conducting unilateral Rapid Impact and Needs Assessments). It also created tensions within those country offices between colleagues and teams who were not allowed to share data with each other.

The SEIA data was not compatible with the PDNAs, and not publicly released (and indeed the SEIA does not appear to have been finalised 6 months after the cyclone). One apparent benefit was that an early summary presentation of the SEIA by OCHA and UNDP in New York in mid-May provided an opportunity to convene donors and permanent representatives, and keep their attention on Mozambique (a precursor to the pledging conference).



Support for the UN system and for Host Government Planning



REPUBLIC OF MOZAMBIQUE

Ministry of Public Works, Housing and Water Resources
Cabinet for Post Idai Reconstruction

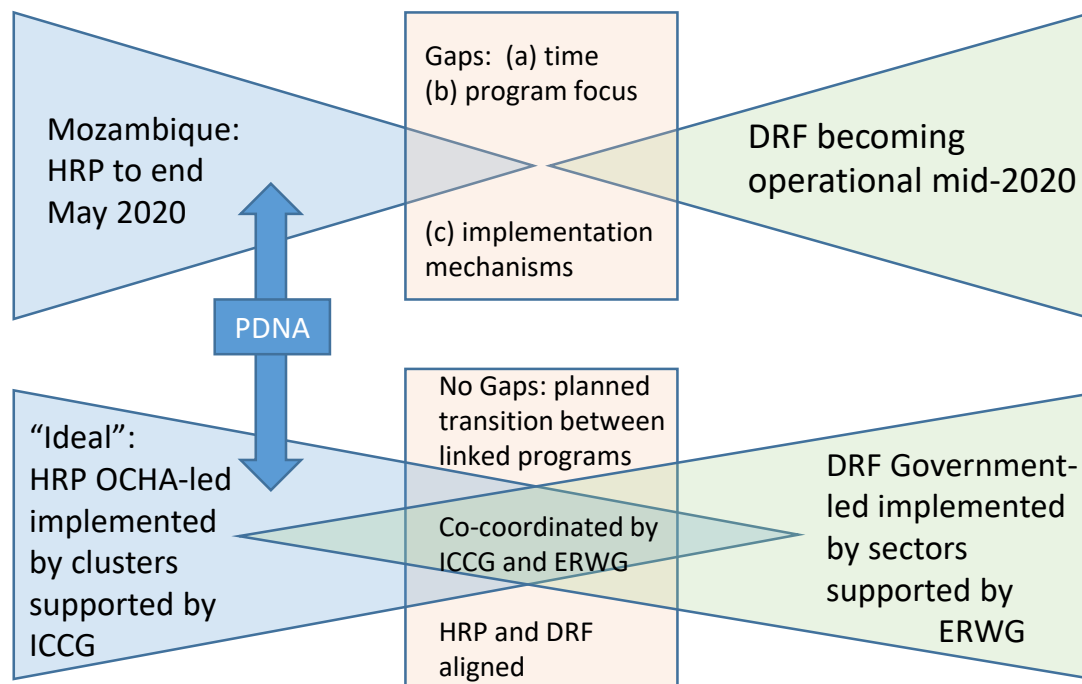
DISASTER RECOVERY FRAMEWORK

15 AUGUST 2019

Disaster Recovery Framework

Only Mozambique followed through the whole recovery programme cycle from PDNA to a DRF and a UN-managed funding and programming mechanism (Recovery Facility). The Mozambique DRF is well-regarded by donors and has full Government ownership (cabinet-approved), although some UNDP staff and partners expressed the view that it was light on Disaster Risk Reduction. The Disaster Recovery Framework for Malawi was released in late October, and Zimbabwe's is still in the drafting stage, possibly too late to be useful.

In Mozambique, there was a perception from the humanitarian community that the DRF guidance (a joint World Bank/UNDP/EU guide updated in 2015) has a bias towards infrastructure, government institutions and multilateral delivery (UN agencies and development banks), and that as a result there is too much of a gap between the Mozambique DRF on the one hand, and the service-orientation with non-Government delivery of the HRP on the other.



Above is what happened: below would be an ideal scenario for a sudden-onset situation.



What went well

Resource mobilisation, for the affected countries and for UNDP

The donor conference

Asymmetrical donor interest

The donor and funding environments in the three countries were very different. In Zimbabwe the economic situation and government-donor relations were such that funding was highly constrained, and there was no appetite for a donor conference.

In Malawi, donor interest was lukewarm. More importantly, donors felt that it would not have been appropriate to (further) politicize recovery by convening a recovery conference in the midst of presidential elections. However, the high level of funding for the Malawi Flood Response Plan might have been a spinoff from the attention generated by Idai.

Donors expressed interest early in Mozambique, and the push through to a DRF and donor conference was envisaged by UNDP at the outset, embedded in the SURGE plan and became the focus of UNDP advocacy. To support the timely and quality trifecta of a PDNA, DRF and Donor Conference, UNDP deployed a strong team consisting of a PDNA specialist (and technical team members), a DRF specialist, and a Senior Recovery Advisor specialised in strategic planning and government relations. The conference was prepared through UNDP-led briefings and advocacy with Permanent Representatives in New York, including UNDP facilitation for the President of Mozambique to meet with the UN Secretary-General and Bill Clinton. In addition, donors in Maputo were engaged early and often.

The combination of the quality analysis and planning with UNDP's facilitation of donor relationships culminated in a two-day meeting of approximately 700 people in the heart of the affected region, including several senior donor and UN officials and the President of Mozambique.

This meeting on 31 May-1 June took place 10 weeks after the disaster struck Mozambique. Perhaps most importantly of all, the Government of Mozambique felt that this was their conference, not UNDP's.

Why does a Donor Conference matter?

The key thing about a donor conference is not so much the event itself, but the hard deadline it creates and which drives a planning and pledging process.

It is this deadline for a high profile event involving senior officials that (a) stimulates stakeholders and Government to produce the PDNA and DRF, and that (b) stimulates donors to decide on their financial responses.

Without the event, the components of planning and financing would not come together and would not obtain the critical mass required to convert into a significant new programme of support. AfDB, EU, WB all said they were pressured by the deadline to get approvals ready: allowing a critical mass and synchronised response.



What went well

THE SUPPORT TO GOVT
IN PREPARATION OF
CONFERENCE AND
MOBILIZATION OF
RESOURCES EVEN
AFTER THE CONFERENCE
BECAUSE
DONORS ARE WILLING
TO SUPPORT, EVEN NOW
MOBILIZATION IS STILL
A SUCCESS

Resource mobilisation, for the affected countries and for UNDP

The Facility and the Basket Fund

Limited resources for recovery programmes in Zimbabwe and Malawi

The economic and political situation of Zimbabwe is such that traditional donors are highly constrained in their development investments, to the point that they were not open to reallocating resources to Idai recovery from the Zimbabwe Resilience Building Fund. The World Bank was able to allocate \$72 million from its Crisis Response Window, which will be administered by UNOPS not by UNDP. This decision was reportedly based on a World Bank-UNOPS programming and financial model established in other crises, and where UNOPS has been determined to be quicker, more flexible and lower-cost (lower General Management Support Fee than UNDP). On the side, UNDP will receive \$3 million from the State and Peacebuilding Fund to strengthen Government capacity, and UNDP might yet receive a portion of the UNOPS-managed project.

In Malawi, which is subject to frequent flooding, donors preferred to stick with and enhance their existing flood response and resilience mechanisms rather than create a major new programme for (relatively-speaking) a mid-sized disaster.

Golden opportunity in Mozambique

Only in Mozambique were all the conditions in place for a major new boost of financial support. Four factors combined to create a golden opportunity: (a) the disaster was large and visible, not competing for attention with other disasters at the same time, and thus attracted undivided media and donor attention; (b) UNDP facilitated a strong PDNA and donor conference to solicit significant pledging, and thereby also restored confidence in UNDP in Mozambique; (c) importantly, the Government is not trusted for direct budget support and the World Bank is not in a position to set up a new Trust Fund – leaving UNDP as the most credible candidate to facilitate a recovery programme; (d) UNDP followed through with a strong Disaster Recovery Framework and a programmatic offer in the form of the Recovery Facility, supported by a Basket Fund. The anchor donor was the EU, and the Netherlands, Canada, Norway, Finland and Italy have subsequently committed to join.

The important thing to note is that the significant success achieved by Mozambique CO was the result of several enabling factors - including well-timed and very experienced technical inputs and institutional support. But it cannot be assumed that a high-quality PDNA, donor conference and DRF would, in themselves, be sufficient in other contexts.



Summary scorecard

	Mozambique	Zimbabwe	Malawi
Crisis Board performance			
RBA support for the COs			
CO leadership			
Use of fast-track financing			
Staff deployments			
Consultant deployments			
SURGE mission			
SURGE Plan			
SURGE transition			
UNDP adaptability			
Effectiveness of ER Working Group			
Clarity regarding UNDP role in ER			
Mainstreaming of ER in response			
Support to RCO			
Support to OCHA			
UNDP role in initial assessment			
PDNA			
SEIA			
Development donor engagement			
RRF/DRF			
Short-term resource-mobilisation for UNDP			
Long-term resource-mobilisation for UNDP			
Overall assessment of immediate response			
Overall assessment of recovery phase			

Excellent (little room for improvement)
Good (some aspects could have been better)
Sufficient (considering in the circumstances)
Some room for improvement
Has not succeeded (or not succeeded yet)
Not applicable/not sought or requested or needed



Recommendations



To Crisis Bureau

Training for COs
(Disaster prone or regional)
on surge &
best practices

ALL UNDP STAFF WORKING
IN COUNTRIES VULNERABLE
TO CLIMATE RELATED EVENTS
SHOULD BE TRAINED / UNDER-
TAKE CRISIS RESPONSE LEAR-
NING TOOL AND UNDERTAKE
A SIMULATION EXERCISE AT
LEAST ONCE A YEAR

Contingency planning and preparedness in high-risk countries

There was an overwhelming recommendation from UNDP staff that the Crisis Bureau should support RBx to ensure that all countries at high risk of a sudden onset natural disaster (a) receive crisis response and ER training, including RRs and DRR, (b) build likely response scenarios and conduct periodic simulations, (c) based on the likely scenarios, have specific contingency plans (including lists of locally-available expertise to contact at short notice), and SoPs for the most likely events.

ENSURE THAT
COUNTRY OFFICES
HAVE EMERGENCY
RESPONSE PLANS
IN PLACE WITH
UNDP'S ROLE
CLEARLY STATED

Early Recovery in sudden-onset crises

Crisis Bureau to support a process whereby UNDP takes a clear public position on its role in Early Recovery, and disseminates this position to UNDP staff and to key external stakeholders. This should include as a minimum (a) a position on the creation of an Early Recovery Cluster in sudden-onset situations, (b) a statement of UNDP's responsibilities to support the RCO with strategic advice on bridging the humanitarian-development gap, including a decision on who would pay for the deployment of an ERA to the RCO, (c) a description of the possible functions of an Early Recovery Working Group, (d) updated guidance on the GCER (or UNDP) website including a revision of the *Guidance Note on Inter-Cluster Early Recovery*, and *Implementing Early Recovery* (in line with (a) – (c) above).

Crisis Board

Crisis Bureau to modify the Crisis Board SoPs to include (a) guidance on how to make a response-framing early and clear decision about whether to commit to immediate response (with required “all-in” resources) or not, and (b) a stock-taking meeting at approximately the 3-month mark in order to assess progress of the response and readiness for transition.

Office in a box

In order to facilitate quick start-up in a new location, procure/assemble and possibly pre-position a number of “Offices-in-a-Box,” including more standardized workflow tools (fewer reference documents and more pre-approved templates) and simplified procurement and staffing procedures.



UN
DP

To Crisis Bureau

TO CB: (AAR)
 - TO ORGANIZE REVIEWS OF SURGE PLAN IMPLEMENTATION (INCLUDING DEPLOYMENTS) WHILE THE SURGE PLAN IS BEING IMPLEMENTED.
 - TO HAVE PERIODIC DEPLOYMENTS FROM STAFF THAT DRAFTED THE SURGE PLAN TO CO ~~WITH~~ TO REORIENT THE PLAN AND DEPLOYMENTS (UPDATE PLAN)

RBA (M/E)
 SURGE Planning Team composition to include RBA desk officer and/or HwB RBA expert.

Deployments

Crisis Bureau should (a) as much as possible, deploy staff as first responders and strengthen organisational discipline to release pre-qualified staff; (b) automatically and immediately deploy operations support to situations where the UNDP response is expected to be major and the CO operational capacity is weak, factoring in that UNDP might in some cases also be expected to support other agency employees notably RCO and OCHA; (c) ensure CO Procurement Units are fully aware of and equipped to action administrative workflows to fast-track SURGE deployees in-country; (d) ensure that deployments follow a sequence determined by the CO, and that deployee TORs are contextually-adjusted and fully owned by the CO, with each deployee clearly reporting to a responsible officer within the CO; (e) as much as possible, deploy the first responder ERAs so that they can engage with the SURGE planning mission and thereby facilitate continuity; (f) be rigorous in challenging the CO to demonstrate that the enabling conditions for success are in place (i.e. clear demand for the technical services from local actors or probable projects, logistics and interpreter support) before deploying technical experts; (g) further deepen the roster of ICs, in particular the strategic planning and government relations profile of a Senior Recovery Advisor, and keep that roster refreshed.

SURGE Plan

In large-scale responses, a two-phase SURGE deployment plan is recommended (0-3 and 4-6 month phases, following the Idai experience). However, in addition to ongoing exchanges between Crisis Bureau and RBx regarding the fine-tuning of each deployment, the plan should be validated and updated after 2-3 months before triggering the second wave of experts. The SURGE planning mission (and possibly a mid-response validation exercise) could include an officer from the HQs-based country oversight team – to help ensure understanding and follow-up from the RBx.

Recognising that a SURGE Plan is not a country-specific Early Recovery strategy/plan, Crisis Bureau needs to further consider what would be the preferred process, format and timing for a CO to develop a country-specific ER strategy.

IASC

Crisis Bureau should (a) obtain a decision from the IASC on the future of the ER cluster and on the approach to ER in humanitarian response (if the current guidance needs updating), (b) ask IASC to include ER as an explicit component of Operational Peer Reviews and Inter-Agency Humanitarian Evaluations, and (c) together with the World Bank, consider how the guidance for HRPs and DRFs can be better aligned to facilitate the easy transition of activities and coordination mechanisms from one framework to the other.



To RB Africa

Contingency planning and preparedness in high-risk countries

RBA should assess the sudden-onset disaster risk profile of all countries in its jurisdiction, and in conjunction with Crisis Bureau ensure that all COs in countries identified at high risk of a sudden onset natural disaster: (a) receive crisis response and ER training, including RRs and DRR; (b) build likely response scenarios and conduct periodic simulations; and (c) based on the likely scenarios, have specific contingency plans and SoPs for the most likely events, including a list (to be updated periodically) of local ICs and RBA staff who could be deployed as first responders in the first few days of a major crisis.

Crisis response

In a situation requiring a high level of response (L3) and where the CO does not have the capacity to lead the response as well as manage the regular country programme, deploy an additional DRR dedicated to the coordination of UNDP's response and eventual transition.

Needs Assessment and Recovery Planning

Support the established needs assessment and recovery planning mechanisms (PDNA and DRF), and only conduct supplementary assessments when it is determined that the established mechanisms will not be used.



To other UNDP Bureaux

To RBx

Every RB should assess the sudden-onset disaster risk profile of the countries in its jurisdiction, and in conjunction with Crisis Bureau ensure that all COs in countries at high risk of a sudden onset natural disaster (a) receive crisis response and ER training, including RRs and DRR, (b) build likely response scenarios and conduct periodic simulations, and (c) based on the likely scenarios, have specific contingency plans and SoPs for the most likely events, including a list (to be updated periodically) of local ICs and RB staff who could be deployed as first responders in the first few days of a major crisis.

Every RB should ensure that RRs and candidates in the RR pool are trained in the essentials of UNDP's role in a crisis, and in UNDP's ER processes and tools.

While there is no specific recommendation on SURGE transition, since this would vary so much by context, it is important to remind RBx that the RBx is accountable for ensuring a smooth transition from the SURGE team. RBx needs to start this transition planning early, and ensure that an affordable and "best fit" successor team is in place in time to take over from the SURGE deployees when they leave (usually after 3 or 6 months).

To BMS

Provide to Crisis Bureau an updated roster of operations staff (in HQs and in the RBx) who can be rapidly deployed into a crisis situation, not as trainers and advisors, but as hands-on implementers of operational functions.

Lead a process (supported by Crisis Bureau and RBx) to (a) increase awareness of existing administrative policies and procedures that can be used in crisis situations, and (b) develop further simplified procurement and staffing procedures that can be used to establish an official presence in a new location (part of the Box) and kick-start ER activities.

To BERA communications

There was a general sense from staff that UNDP should seek to be more visible at the early stage, and that UNDP should be generating communications material, but it was not clear if it was effective. The recommendation to BERA is to consider carrying out a study of the effectiveness of communications activities in crisis situations, in order to determine which types of communications activity (published bulletins, website material, social media feeds, facilitated donor visits etc) are most effective at obtaining the desired communications results.

Methodology for Data Collection

Travel to five locations and supplementary Skype interviews

Total Level of Effort: 24 days

New York: 1 day with staff workshop

Maputo: 2 days with staff workshop

Beira: 2 days with staff workshop

Harare: 1 day with staff workshop

Lilongwe: 2 days (planned workshop cancelled due to security restrictions)

Key Stakeholder Interviews (n = 74) and Workshop participants (n = 39)

Current & former UNDP staff (n = 60)

Local partners, including private (n = 17)

Other UN agencies (n = 16)

Government officials (n = 13)

Donors & development banks (n = 4)

Standby partners (n = 3)

Review of relevant UNDP and related documents (n = 81)

UNDP documents

- Crisis Board and CMST
- SURGE
- ER WG TORs
- Business Case (Beira)
- Mission reports
- PDNAs and SEIAs
- DRFs

- HRP and related humanitarian documents

Crisis Response Exigency Memo
Crisis Response Level: L2
Country: MOZAMBIQUE



This document is completed during Crisis Board meeting. It is then printed and signed by the Chair of the Crisis Board. Decisions are posted on CRU hosted Crisis Response Portal and distributed electronically by CB secretariat.

UNDP Crisis Response Level Criteria¹:

Scale	☐ L1	☐ L2	☒ L3
Urgency	☐ L1	☐ L2	☒ L3
Complexity	☐ L1	☐ L2	☒ L3
Response Capacity ²	☐ L1	☐ L2	☒ L3
Reputational Risk ³	☐ L1	☐ L2	☒ L3

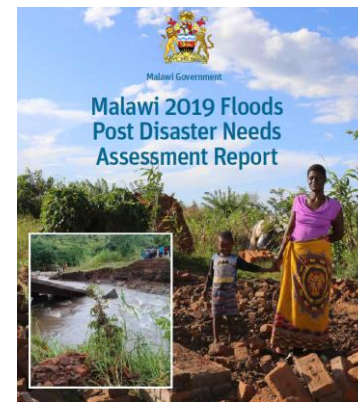
Crisis Board Determined Crisis Response Level (mark when designated):

☐ Level 1 ☒ Level 2 ☐ Level 3

UNDP SURGE PLAN CYCLONE IDAI AND FLOODS MALAWI, MOZAMBIQUE AND ZIMBABWE



April 2019



GFDRR



THE WORLD BANK



Annexes

Interviewees and Workshop participants

Maputo		
Cecilia	Aipira	UNDP
Emma	Batey	OCHA
Claudia	Bulhe	European Union
Tafara	Chekai	UNDP
Nareya	Chilengue	UNWOMEN
Marco Luigi	Corsi	UNICEF
Wouter	De Cuyper	UNDP
Abdourahmane	Dia	UNDP
Godwill	Enow-Ebot	UNDP
Isabel	Faria de Almeida	European Union
Igor	Felice	ILO
Eduardo	Fujikawa	UNDP
Mytra	Kaulard	UN RCO
Titus	Kuuyuor	UNDP
James	Lattimer	WFP
Deodat	Maharaj	UNDP
Karin	Manente	WFP
Elevina	Martins	UNDP
Eunice	Mucache	UNDP
Manuela	Muianga	UNDP
Mamadou	N'Daw	UNDP
Amy	Nkuna	UNDP
Verity	Nyagah	UNDP
Francisco	Pereira	Government
Eunice	Raiba	UNDP
Habiba	Rodolfo	UNDP
Higino	Rodrigues	Government
Francisco	Roquette	UNDP
Mauro	Salia	UNDP
Joana	Sampainho	UNDP
Alfredo	Teixeira	UNDP
Cesar	Tique	AfDB
Ana Nemba	Uaiene	Government
Krishna	Vatsa	UNDP
Boaventura	Veja	UNWOMEN
Dellia	Yerokun	UNDP
Luis	Zaqueu	UNDP

Harare		
Kamilla	Adgamova	UNDP
Ethel	Bangwayo	UNDP
Allen	Cahritewi	CBM
Anesu	Freddy	UNDP
Maria	Goss	Practical Action
Juliet	Gwenzi	UNDP
Toendepi	Kamusewa	Save the Children
Anne	Madzara	UNDP
Gift	Mashango	Save the Children
Vrindhah	MC	UNDP
Leslie	Mhara	UNOPS
Madelena	Monoja	UNDP
Martha	Mudhingi	UNDP
Joseph	Mutsigwa	UNDP
Nathan	Nkomo	Government
Patrick	Phipps	OCHA
Gabriella	Praodin	Goal
Cowen	Shoko	Mercy Corps
Bickram	Shrestha	UNDP
Sibangai	Shumba	Save the Children
Tariro	Tserayi	World Bank
Georges	Van Montfort	UNDP
Sarka	Vickova	WFP

New York		
Mohamed	Abchir	UNDP
Muni	Ahlawat	UNDP
Nesreen	Al-Hebshi	UNDP
Fabrizio	Andreuzzi	UNDP
Adam	Cathro	UNDP
Saumik	De	UNDP
Nicoleta	Dmitru	UNDP
Ahunna	Eziakonwa	UNDP
Jeannette	Fernandez-Castro	UNDP
Noura	Hamladji	UNDP
Bruno	Lemarquis	UNDP
Tsegaye	Lemma	UNDP
Rebecca	Reynolds	UNDP
Helina	Tadesse	UNDP
Duhitha	Wijeyratne	UNDP

Lilongwe		
Prisca	Chisala	Malawi Red Cross
Laura	Hastings	OCHA
Kevin	Kalonga	Habitat for Humanity
Shikegi	Komatsubara	UNDP
McBain	Laiton	Malawi Red Cross
	Kanongodza	
Maureen	Lance-Onyeiwu	UNDP
Claire	Medina	UNDP
Wilson	Moleni	Government
Francis	Nkoka	World Bank
Sothini	Nyirenda	UNDP
Andrew	Spezowka	UNDP
Maria Jose	Torres	UN RCO

Beira		
Rocha	Alface	Government
Aksana	Almaeira	Young Africa
Figueiredo	Araujo	UNDP
Diogo	Borges	Government
Carla	de Almeida	Government
Helder	Domingos	CAM
Eduardo	Elias	Government
Paulo	Ghizu	CAM
Moses	Kakanu	ADEL
Camille	Laude	MSB
Francisco	Major	Government
Augusto	Manhoca	Government
Jose	Manuel	Government
Kerry	McBroom	IOM
Hari Krishna	Nibanupudi	MSB
Harison	Nozoka	UNDP
Frederic	Riopel	IFRC
Ravy	Serra	UNDP
Ghulam	Sherani	UNDP
David	Smith	MSB
Hamid	Taibo	ADEL
Miguel	Tapia	Young Africa
Paolo	Thomas	Government
Massimiliano	Tozzi	UNDP
Kamillah	Vali	UNDP
Ryan	Webb	WFP



Workshop summaries

What went well

New York

Cooperation between Bureaux at HQs level (unaffected by HQs restructuring)
SURGE Plan (strong team, timely mission, quality SURGE Plan)
Good analysis of country context to best position UNDP's response
Responsiveness to CO requests, and adaptation to CO specific needs
Quick deployment of quality experts, specially first batch of ERAs
Collaboration with the World Bank (Mozambique) led to a stronger donor conference
In Mozambique: UNDP positioned well by PDNA, Donor Conference, DRF and Recovery Facility

Maputo

RBA recognition of the limited capacity and need for immediate support for CO (as well as for ER)
Despite stressful situation national staff came together and rose to the challenge
Rapid deployment of early recovery team and technical experts
Quick allocations of funding from CO resources and from HQs
Quick deployment of "strategic team" to do PDNA, Donor Conference, DRF, Facility
Quality and participatory PDNA and DRF
Pledging conference (turning point for Mozambique and UNDP)
ER Facility (repositioned UNDP with Govt and with donors)
Government engagement in PDNA, Donor Conference and Facility

Beira

Setting up sub-office (although still not fully autonomous)
Government engagement including local government
Strong Beira team worked well together
Good SURGE deployments
Timely PDNA and Donor Conference
Good Resource Mobilisation/Recovery Facility

Harare

Rapid deployment of ERA
Early Interagency assessment mission
Rapid recruitment of consulting support
Inter-Agency Coordination in general, and of Early Recovery
Responsive to Govt eg on lessons learned process
Consideration of programme reorientation - not just new programming
Early and quick decision on initial funding (500k)



Workshop summaries

What did not go well

New York

Early Recovery activities in the field (Moz and Malawi) started late due to lack of project staff
Weak communication at the beginning
Early deployed senior managers to Mozambique should have been seasoned crisis response experts
Confusion in messaging over whether to activate an Early Recovery cluster, or what to do instead
Insufficient guidance and support with setting up a field office (SoPs, Delegation of Authorities)
Lack of coordination between the SEIA and the PDNA
SEIA became too heavy, changed purpose and scope, and was eventually delayed so less useful
Mozambique was not ready to receive a large influx of deployed experts
Insufficient operational support to COs especially to Maputo

Maputo

Not enough staff in Maputo or in the field for some time: staff overloaded
Operations staff overloaded and got little extra support
Poor quality of some consultants
Not clear to CO what they needed to do to support the SURGE deployees
Fragmented SURGE deployment because CO not clear on objectives, reporting lines etc
Too much turnover of temporary staff and employees: no stability
No “unified strategy” for the CO increased the workload with back-and-forth
No clear lines of communication with deployed teams, and with Beira
Lack of coordination on the PDNA and SEIA
Early Recovery Cluster was ignored by the HCT

Beira

No clear vision and direction for UNDP to respond to disaster at the initial stage
SURGE employee TORs too generic and not really tailored to the local context
Insufficient induction/training of new recruits and employees
Lack of clear reporting relationship to Maputo (poor internal coordination)
Too little support from Maputo eg procurement delays, no clear comms and admin systems
Too much reliance on SURGE in field and Maputo: disconnected from CO team

Harare

Lack of clarity from HQs on joint tasking/reporting vs country-specific (esp on Comms)
Lack of field deployment (local level) disconnected UNDP from other actors and local Govt
SEIA shifting goalposts – objective and scope kept changing, conflicting data
Hard to pull coherent ER data from ER partners
ER actors more oriented towards institutional interests than collective interests



Workshop summaries

Lessons learned

New York

COs have their own resources that can be better mobilised to support response
Key deployed experts should be assigned for longer than 3 months
Deployments should be thoughtfully sequenced for effectiveness and to reduce burden on CO
Take time to orient incoming and outgoing employees so they can be operational quicker
Need to pre-position capacity especially operations support when a major crisis is imminent
Make sure you are always responsive to the CO's priorities and needs
CO national staff are key and need to be recognized, involved and supported
Best time to deploy partnerships/RM experts is just before the PDNA is finished
A crisis can also be an opportunity "Don't let a crisis go to waste"

Maputo

SURGE employees too short-term and there is disruption with turnover
Leadership, good coordination and teamwork make for a more effective response
From the beginning actors expect UNDP to provide clear guidance on Early Recovery
Having the language skills to function in the context is essential
All UNDP staff in crisis-prone country should be trained and have clear roles in a response
HQs should lighten the reporting load on the CO in a crisis: too much time briefing not doing

Harare

Need to be timely and have good info/quality expertise in order to convene and lead
Need to accelerate internal processes in an emergency, and share info quickly
Understand core strengths, decide areas of intervention, then commit to them

Beira

[Beira workshop focused more specifically on recommendations than lessons learned]